

Haitong Bank — Corporate Banking Analyst

Interview Preparation Handbook

Candidate: Horace Loi

Target role: Corporate Banking, Analyst — Haitong Bank, Macau Branch

Interviewer: Head of Corporate Finance, Haitong Bank Macau Branch

How to use this: placeholders in square brackets [] are where you fill in your own real details. Model answers are written to be spoken aloud — rehearse them. Priority tags: [MUST] = must memorise, [KEY] = key, [KNOW] = be familiar.

1. The Role & The Bank at a Glance

Company background (what the interviewer wants to hear you understand)

Point	Detail
Parent / regulation	Haitong Bank S.A. — incorporated in Lisbon, Portugal; EU-regulated (Banco de Portugal / ECB)
Shareholder	Wholly-owned subsidiary of Guotai Haitong Securities (China's largest brokerage post-2025 merger)
Macau Branch role	Preferred hub for Greater Bay Area (GBA) bond issuance + cross-border strategic bridgehead
Business scope	Structured finance, capital markets, M&A, fixed income, corporate derivatives, asset management
Strategic logic	Combine decades of European / Latin American franchises with China-related business; diversify Macau's financial activity

The six core responsibilities of the role

#	Responsibility	Keyword
1	Analyse transaction documents (info memo, financial model, term sheet)	Transaction docs
2	Analyse industry dynamics	Industry dynamics
3	Analyse the client's competitive advantages and risks	Client risk & edge
4	Prepare internal reports (presentation, term sheet, cash flow analysis)	Internal reports
5	Conduct customer onboarding (KYC)	Onboarding / KYC
6	Transaction monitoring and reviews	Transaction monitoring

Profile required

- Fluency in English and Mandarin (**mandatory**)
- Quick learner — able to understand a new industry / client fast
- Basic accounting knowledge, able to conduct financial analysis
- Good interpersonal skills — effective in presentations and with clients
- Highly organised, detail-oriented, proactive
- Fresh graduates welcome (= your experience is well above the bar)

2. Job Requirements × Your CV

JD requirement	Your evidence (straight from your CV)	Match
Analyse info memo / term sheet / financial model	"Reviewed info memos, financial models and term sheets"	✓ Full
Industry dynamics analysis	"Analysed industry dynamics, competitive landscapes"	✓ Full
Cash flow analysis / internal reports	"drafted internal credit reports with cash flow analysis, sensitivity testing"	✓ Full
KYC / customer onboarding	"Conducted customer onboarding, ongoing due diligence"	✓ Full
Transaction monitoring	"post-loan reviews to safeguard asset quality"	✓ Full
Fluent English + Mandarin	"Full Professional English and Mandarin"	✓ Full
Quick learner / new industries	Moved from digital-finance PM to corporate banking RM; self-taught Python/SQL	✓ Proven
Detail-oriented, proactive	"Detail-oriented · Proactive" + zero-violation record	✓ Quantified
Cantonese (local Macau edge)	Native Cantonese	✓ Hidden plus

Bottom line: you are a high-match candidate, far above the fresh-graduate bar. Your job in the interview is not to "prove you're good enough" — it's to make them feel that **not hiring you would be a loss**.

Your five core selling points (say these proactively)

1. **USD 2bn+ of deal experience** — walking into an Analyst interview with that number is highly persuasive
2. **Cross-border product experience** — Haitong's whole strategy is cross-border; you have inbound / outbound / local regime experience
3. **RMB internationalisation tracking** — aligned with Haitong's GBA bond-hub strategy
4. **Trilingual (Cantonese / English / Mandarin)** — for local Macau client development, Cantonese is a hidden edge
5. **Technical tools (Python / SQL)** — most analysts can't; a differentiator

3. How to Make the Interviewer Feel You're Indispensable

Core mindset shift: not "how do I prove I'm good enough?" but **"how do I make him afraid to lose me?"**

1) Solve his pain before he raises it

The Macau Branch is still in build-up phase — likely short-staffed, needs people who can contribute immediately, and is building a local client network. Bake the answer into your opening:

SAY THIS

"I understand the Macau Branch is still in its build-up phase. I bring five years of local corporate client experience, I know the AMCM regulatory framework, and I have hands-on cross-border deal experience. I'm not here to learn the basics — I'm here to contribute."

2) Flip your "weakness" into their "reason" (pre-empt it)

Proactively address the "an RM coming in as an Analyst — will he leave quickly?" doubt — see Q&A A3. Turn it into a "you come out ahead" argument.

3) Use "we" instead of "I would"

Weak candidate	You should say
"If I join, I will..."	"Our clients in this area..."
"I think this role..."	"The way our team handles this kind of deal..."

Linguistically placing yourself inside his team makes him picture you already working there.

4) Prepare a "research bomb"

Find something he wouldn't expect you to know (a recent Haitong GBA bond deal / a new AMCM cross-border policy / the bank's own financial disclosures) and bring it up naturally:

SAY THIS

"I noticed AMCM updated its cross-border bond guidance — that should be good news for your GBA bond issuance plans. I'm curious whether the team is already looking at that opportunity?"

5) Ask for the job at the close (99% of candidates won't)

See Q&A E1 — show confidence, invite his concerns, convey genuine desire.

4. STAR Flagship Deal

Take-private acquisition financing of Dali Foods Group (3799.HK)

Keep the spoken version to ~3 minutes, weighted on the Action — especially the "cross-border cash path." Memorise the public facts below (HK\$3.75, founder Xu Shihui, scheme of arrangement, delisted 2023). Swap in your real numbers wherever you have them.

Deal fact sheet (your memory anchors)

Item	Detail
Target	Dali Foods Group (3799.HK; Cayman-incorporated, HK-listed)
Main brands	Daliyuan, Haochidian, Copico, Lehu, Doubendou, Heqizheng
Privatising party	Founder Xu Shihui and family, via an offshore SPV offeror
Method	Scheme of arrangement
Cancellation price	HK\$3.75 per share
Family stake	~85%, buying out the ~15% minority
Total consideration	~ HK\$7.6 billion (~USD 970 million)
Completion	Announced late 2022, delisted in 2023

S — Situation

SAY THIS

"The flagship deal I led was the acquisition financing for the take-private of Dali Foods Group — a Hong Kong-listed Chinese food and beverage giant, stock code 3799, home to brands like Daliyuan, Lehu, and Doubendou. In late 2022, the founder Mr. Xu Shihui and his family proposed to privatize the company at HK\$3.75 per share by way of a scheme of arrangement. The family already held about 85%, so the financing was needed to buy out the roughly 15% minority — a total consideration of around HK\$7.6 billion.

The structure was genuinely cross-border: a Cayman-incorporated, Hong Kong-listed company, an offshore offeror vehicle, but all the real operating cash sitting onshore in Fujian, in renminbi. That mismatch — offshore debt, onshore cash — was the heart of the deal."

T — Task

SAY THIS

"I was the lead analyst and execution lead for our branch's participation as a mandated lead arranger in the syndicated facility. I owned four things end-to-end: the credit analysis and financial model, the review of transaction and security documents, the KYC and source-of-wealth work on the offeror and the ultimate beneficial owners, and the internal credit paper for our committee. I also had to satisfy the 'certain funds' requirement — under the Takeovers Code, the financing has to be fully committed before the offer can even be announced, so there was no room for soft conditions."

A — Action (the longest part)

SAY THIS

"Let me walk through what I did.

First, structure and document analysis. I flagged the key structural issue early: the debt sits at the offshore acquisition vehicle, but repayment depends entirely on dividends being upstreamed from the onshore Fujian operating company. So I built the credit case around that cash path — PRC distributable profits, the 10% withholding tax on outbound dividends, and the SAFE and FX approvals needed to convert renminbi and remit offshore.

Second, the financial model. Dali was a strong credit — a cash-generative consumer staples business with revenue around RMB 20 billion, net profit around RMB 3 billion, and historically low leverage. I modelled the post-deal capital structure and deleveraging profile. Even with the new acquisition debt, net debt to EBITDA came in under 2 times, and DSCR held comfortably above 1.5 times. Then I stress-tested three scenarios: base case, a revenue decline in the traditional snack segment, and — critically — a renminbi depreciation scenario, because the cash is in RMB but debt service is in Hong Kong dollars.

Third, industry analysis. I mapped Dali against peers like Want Want, Tingyi, and Nongfu Spring. The story was a mature, declining traditional snack business funding the growth of newer categories — soy milk and energy drinks. That mix mattered for how durable the cash flow was over the loan tenor.

Fourth, security and covenants. Because repayment relied on that cross-border cash path, I pushed for a share charge over the privatized company, a dividend lock-up and cash sweep mechanism, and leverage and DSCR covenants with early-warning triggers — so we would know well before any breach.

Fifth, coordination. I worked with Hong Kong, Cayman, BVI, and PRC counsel on the multi-jurisdiction security package, with compliance on the founder's source of wealth, and with the syndicate on the commitment. I also wrote the full credit approval paper for committee."

R — Result

SAY THIS

"The scheme was approved by the shareholders and the court. The facility funded the full consideration on a certain-funds basis, and Dali was delisted from the Hong Kong Stock Exchange in 2023. Because the underlying business was so cash-generative, deleveraging ran ahead of plan, and the cross-border dividend mechanics I had modelled worked exactly as expected. For our branch, it was one of the largest single transactions that year. On a personal level, leading a listed-company take-private — with full takeovers-code discipline and cross-border complexity — is the deal I'm proudest of, and it's the clearest example of why I want to do more of this kind of work at Haitong."

Privatization-specific follow-ups (the interviewer will drill these)

Follow-up	Key points to answer
What is a scheme of arrangement?	A court-approved take-private. 75% by value in favour + no more than 10% against + court sanction → binds 100% of shareholders, enabling a clean full delisting
What was the biggest credit risk?	The cross-border cash path: debt offshore in HKD, repayment depends on RMB profits upstreamed onshore → exposed to the 10% withholding tax, SAFE approvals, and RMB depreciation
What does "certain funds" mean?	Takeovers Code: financing must be fully committed before announcement — no MAC walk-away clause → your credit analysis must be airtight upfront
How did you get comfortable with the founder? (KYC)	Credit: the operating company's cash flow was strong and stable. Compliance: enhanced KYC on the Xu family — source of wealth, track record as controlling shareholders since the 2015 IPO, credible long-term value rationale
Why privatize at HK\$3.75?	A discount to the IPO valuation; the family judged the market was undervaluing the company long-term and bought out minorities at the low

5. Financial Modeling Crash Course

The three statements · cash flow estimation · DSCR

How the three statements link (memorise)

```
INCOME STATEMENT      -> how much you earned (accrual basis)
    | Net Income
    v
BALANCE SHEET         -> what you own / owe (a point in time)
    ^ Cash linkage
    v
CASH FLOW STATEMENT   -> real cash in and out (over a period)
```

Link	Relationship
Net Income -> Balance Sheet	Net income flows into Retained Earnings, increasing equity
Net Income -> Cash Flow	Net income is the starting line of the cash flow statement (indirect method)
Cash Flow -> Balance Sheet	Ending cash balance becomes the Cash line on the balance sheet

Build order (practical logic)

Step 1 – Income Statement (build to EBIT; leave interest blank)

```
Revenue          <- growth-rate assumption
- COGS           <- % of revenue
= Gross Profit
- OpEx (SG&A)     <- % of revenue
= EBITDA
- D&A            <- from the PP&E schedule
= EBIT
- Interest       <- LEAVE BLANK (depends on debt -> cash flow)
= EBT
- Tax            <- tax-rate assumption
= Net Income
```

Step 2 – Balance Sheet (driver-based)

```
Cash              <- the final plug from the cash flow statement
Accounts Receivable <- Days Sales Outstanding (DSO)
Inventory         <- Days Inventory Outstanding (DIO)
PP&E             <- opening + CapEx - Depreciation
Accounts Payable  <- Days Payable Outstanding (DPO)
Debt              <- debt schedule
Retained Earnings <- opening + Net Income - Dividends
```

Step 3 – Cash Flow Statement (the connector)

```
CF0: Net Income + D&A +/- change in Working Capital
CFI: - CapEx
CFF: +/- Debt - Dividends
= Net change in cash + Beginning cash = Ending cash
-> feeds back to Balance Sheet Cash -> check it balances
```

Two traps the interviewer loves

Trap 1 — Circularity: interest -> depends on debt -> depends on cash flow -> depends on net income -> depends on interest. In Excel, break it with iterative calculation or a "circularity switch."

Trap 2 — Working-capital direction on cash: rule of thumb — **an asset going up uses cash; a liability going up saves cash.**

Receivables up -> cash down; Inventory up -> cash down; Payables up -> cash up.

Cash flow estimation formulas (memorise)

Unlevered Free Cash Flow (FCFF)

$EBIT \times (1 - \text{Tax}) = \text{NOPAT}$

+ D&A

- CapEx

- Increase in NWC

= Unlevered FCF

Levered Free Cash Flow (FCFE – for equity holders)

Unlevered FCF

- Interest $\times (1 - \text{Tax})$

- Mandatory Debt Repayment

= Levered FCF

DSCR (Debt Service Coverage Ratio) – what a bank cares about most

$\text{DSCR} = (\text{EBITDA} - \text{Tax} - \text{CapEx}) / (\text{Principal} + \text{Interest})$

> 1.2x is generally the healthy line

6. Q&A — A. About You & Your Motivation

[MUST] A1. Tell me about yourself.

SAY THIS

"My name is Horace Loi. I have over five years in corporate banking at Bank of China, Macau Branch. As a Relationship Manager, I manage a loan portfolio of HKD 8 billion. I've worked on more than 10 large deals — over USD 2 billion in total — covering loans, syndications, and structured financing.

I'm strong in three things: reviewing deal documents, analyzing credit and cash flow, and handling KYC. I also use Python and SQL, so I work with data faster than most bankers.

I want to join Haitong because of its cross-border platform. It combines European banking standards with China business — and I believe that's where the future is."

[KEY] A2. Why Haitong? Why leave Bank of China?

SAY THIS

"Bank of China gave me a strong base in deal execution and credit analysis. But Haitong offers something different. It's an EU-regulated bank with deep China ties. It sits right between European capital markets and Greater China cross-border business.

The Macau Branch has a clear mission — to build the Greater Bay Area bond market. That's a rare chance to help build something new. I think my cross-border experience and language skills fit well, and I can contribute from day one."

[MUST] A3. You're already an RM — why apply for an Analyst role?

SAY THIS

"For me, this is about the platform, not the title. This Analyst role gives me access to new products and clients — structured finance, capital markets advisory, and cross-border deals with a European angle. These are areas I couldn't fully develop at a state-owned commercial bank.

I'm happy to come in as an Analyst if it means growing in this direction. And honestly, it's a good deal for you too — you get an Analyst who already understands clients and the full deal process, not someone who only knows Excel."

A4. Where do you see yourself in 3-5 years?

SAY THIS

"In the short term, I want to go deeper into structured finance and capital markets — areas Haitong is strong in, and areas I haven't fully explored yet.

In three to five years, I'd like to move into a more senior, client-facing role. I'd want to cover cross-border clients in the Greater Bay Area who need both banking and capital market solutions. Haitong's platform is exactly the right place to build that."

A5. What is your biggest weakness?**SAY THIS**

"My main area to improve is capital markets product depth — especially bond issuance and structuring. I've worked near these areas but haven't led them directly. In commercial lending, I used capital markets information, but I didn't create it.

That's actually one reason this role appeals to me — I want to close that gap. I learn fast from real documents and real deals, so I'm confident I can build that knowledge quickly."

7. Q&A — B. Experience & Skills

[MUST] B1. Walk me through a complex deal you worked on.

Answer with the full **STAR story in Section 4** (the Dali Foods take-private). Spoken version ~3 minutes, weighted on the Action and the "cross-border cash path." Keep the public facts (HK\$3.75, Xu Shihui, scheme of arrangement, delisted 2023) exact.

[KEY] B2. How do you check if a company can be trusted with a loan?

SAY THIS

"I use a clear framework. First, the business — its industry, market position, strengths, and main risks. Second, the financials — revenue trend, profit margins, how well it turns profit into cash, and its debt levels. Third, a stress test — what happens to repayment if revenue drops 20% or rates go up? Fourth, the soft factors — management quality, who owns the company, and any legal or regulatory issues. Last, the deal structure itself — collateral, covenants, and whether the terms match the risk."

B3. Tell me about a time you learned a new industry fast.

SAY THIS

"When I moved from digital finance product management to corporate banking, I had to learn credit analysis and deal execution very fast. I broke it into three steps: first, understand the rules and regulations; second, study real documents from closed deals; third, sit in on client meetings and watch how senior bankers handled them."

Within a few months, I could review credit files on my own. The key is not to wait to be taught — you go find the real material and build your own understanding."

8. Q&A — C. Industry & Company Knowledge

[KEY] C1. What do you know about Haitong's strategy in Macau?

SAY THIS

"Haitong's Macau Branch is a key part of the Group's cross-border strategy. Macau has access to both RMB and international finance, so the Branch is being built as a top hub for bond issuance in the Greater Bay Area.

Haitong is EU-regulated, with a Portuguese license. That gives Chinese companies a trusted European standard when they want to reach international capital markets — something most Chinese banks in Macau can't offer. I also understand the Bank wants to help Macau's economy grow beyond gaming and tourism, which fits the wider Greater Bay Area plan."

C2. What are the biggest risks in corporate banking today?

SAY THIS

"I see three. First, credit quality — many Chinese companies that grew too fast now face pressure to refinance, as rates rose and growth slowed. Second, cross-border and regulatory risk — capital controls, RMB swings, and different rules across the mainland, Hong Kong, Macau, and Europe make compliance complex. Third, concentration risk — especially for banks heavily exposed to real estate or one single sector.

So today, early warning signals, strong post-loan monitoring, and clear covenants matter more than ever."

9. Q&A — D. Financial Modeling (Technical)

[MUST] D1. Walk me through the three financial statements and how they connect.

SAY THIS

"There are three statements. The income statement shows profit over a period — from revenue down to net income. The balance sheet is a snapshot at one point in time — assets equal liabilities plus equity. The cash flow statement shows the real cash moving in and out.

They connect in three ways. One: net income goes into retained earnings on the balance sheet. Two: net income is also the starting line of the cash flow statement. Three: the ending cash on the cash flow statement becomes the cash line on the balance sheet.

So the three form a loop. Change one number, and it flows through all three."

D2. If you could use only one statement, which one?

SAY THIS

"The cash flow statement. Profit can be shaped by accounting choices and non-cash items, and the balance sheet is only one point in time. But cash flow is much harder to fake. It shows whether the business really makes enough cash to pay its debt and run itself. In corporate banking, where repayment is what matters most, cash flow is the most honest number."

[KEY] D3. Net income is positive, but the company is running out of cash. How?

SAY THIS

"This is usually a working capital or non-cash problem. A few things could cause it. The company may book sales on credit, so receivables grow but cash hasn't come in. It may be piling up inventory, which locks up cash. It may be spending heavily on equipment — that drains cash but doesn't fully hit the income statement right away. Or it may be repaying loan principal, which isn't an expense but is real cash going out.

The lesson is simple: profit is an accounting idea, but cash is what keeps a business alive."

D4. How do you build a revenue forecast?

SAY THIS

"There are two ways. Top-down starts from the total market size, then applies a market share to get the company's revenue. Bottom-up builds from the unit level — like units sold times price, or for a bank, loan balance times net interest margin.

I usually prefer bottom-up, because it's based on real business drivers and it's easier to stress-test. Either way, I always check the growth rate against the company's history and the industry, to make sure it's realistic."

[MUST] D5. What is free cash flow, and why does a bank care?

SAY THIS

"Free cash flow is the cash a company has left after paying operating costs and buying equipment. It's the cash actually available to repay debt and reward investors.

The formula for unlevered free cash flow is: EBIT times one minus tax, plus depreciation, minus capital spending, minus the increase in working capital.

A bank cares because it tells us if the borrower makes enough cash to pay us back. That's why we focus on DSCR — the Debt Service Coverage Ratio. It's the cash available for debt, divided by the principal and interest due. Above 1.2 times usually means a safe cushion."

D6. Explain the circular reference in a 3-statement model.

SAY THIS

"The loop comes from interest. Interest expense depends on the debt balance. The debt balance depends on how much cash the company has. Cash depends on cash flow. Cash flow depends on net income. And net income depends on interest — so it circles back.

In Excel, you fix this in one of two ways: turn on iterative calculation, or build a 'circularity switch' — a toggle that breaks the loop with a fixed value, so the model doesn't crash while you work on it."

D7. What drivers do you use to project the balance sheet?

SAY THIS

"Most balance sheet items are driven by ratios linked to the income statement. Receivables use Days Sales Outstanding — how long it takes to collect from customers. Inventory uses Days Inventory Outstanding. Payables use Days Payable Outstanding. Fixed assets are the old balance, plus new spending, minus depreciation. Retained earnings are the old balance, plus net income, minus dividends. And cash is the final plug — it comes straight from the cash flow statement.

The rule is: every line should tie to a driver, not just be a guess."

10. Q&A — E. Closing the Interview

[KEY] E1. Closing statement — asking for the job.

SAY THIS

"Before we finish, I want to be straight with you. The more we talk, the more I feel this is the right place for me. I'm not just shopping around. If Haitong is interested, I'm ready to move forward.

Is there anything about my background that worries you? I'd rather answer it now than leave it open."

Good questions to ask the interviewer (shows initiative)

ASK

"What does the current deal pipeline look like for the Corporate Banking team, and what types of cross-border transactions does the Macau Branch focus on most?"

"How does the team work with the European offices and the Hong Kong / mainland China operations on cross-border deals?"

11. Deep Analysis: Strengths, Challenges & Your Value

Based on the Macau Branch financial disclosures 2023–2025 (AMCM Circular 004/B/2024) · your research bomb

This section is what sets you apart from every other candidate. The interviewer is the Head of Corporate Finance — these are the numbers he lives with every day. **Tone is everything:** you are not there to criticise a loss; you come as a partner who understands the structural challenge and is the solution. Affirm the strength first, name the vulnerability, then position yourself as the fix.

Macau Branch — four-year financial picture (MOP)

Metric	2023	2024	2025
Profit for the year	69.6m	54.3m	Loss 13.1m
Total operating income	111.2m	101.2m	23.6m
— Net fee & commission (DCM/M&A)	106.7m	92.8m	8.2m (↓91%)
— Net interest income (NII)	3.5m	11.6m	13.6m (↑)
Operating costs (staff+admin+dep.)	~32.9m	~36.8m	~38.6m (broadly fixed)
Total assets	194.5m	280.9m	502.1m (↑79%)
Loan from Head Office	0	31.8m	274.7m
Banking book (bond investments)	0	221.9m	432.8m
Customer deposits	0	0	0 (licence granted, still unused)

The storyline: from "underwriting boutique" to a forced pivot

- **2023 (peak):** pure fee model. Net profit 69.6m; 96% of income from fees — Joint Lead Manager on 21 bond deals on MOX, first market-maker on MCSD, M&A mandates across Europe / Latin America. Almost no NII, very light balance sheet. A high-margin underwriting + advisory boutique.
- **2024:** net profit 54.3m (↓22%). Still fee-heavy, but starting to build a banking book — first Head Office loan (31.8m) funding bond investments (221.9m); NII more than tripled to 11.6m. Strong DCM (green / sustainable bonds) + cross-border M&A (exclusive buy-side advisor to an industrial-automation player acquiring a French simulation-software firm).
- **2025 (first loss): swung from +54m profit to a -13m loss.** One single, fatal cause — fee & commission income **collapsed 91%** (92.8m → 8.2m) as "mainland Chinese enterprises sharply reduced offshore bond financing." When the one engine stalled, the whole branch went into the red. Meanwhile assets doubled to 502m, funded by a

Head Office loan (274.7m), and interest expense jumped 8.5x (0.5m → 4.5m).

Strengths

- **A unique cross-border platform:** EU-regulated (Banco de Portugal / ECB) + China's largest brokerage parent (Guotai Haitong, ~USD 40bn market cap post-2025 merger). European market access and credibility for Chinese clients — almost impossible to replicate
- **DCM / underwriting brand:** Joint Lead Manager on MOX, first market-maker on MCSD, a first-mover in Macau's bond market, with regulatory tailwinds (CMU-MCSD cross-border linkage)
- **Clean asset quality:** no impairments on the bond book; a small impairment reversal in 2025
- **Clear strategic intent:** already expanding the balance sheet and growing NII — the direction (building a banking book) is right

Challenges (let the numbers talk)

- **A single revenue engine:** over-reliance on mainland offshore bond underwriting fees. When it stalled in 2025, income fell 77% and the branch swung to a loss. That's structural fragility, not a cyclical blip
- **A heavy fixed cost base:** costs of ~38.6m are broadly fixed, but NII is only 13.6m — **net interest income covers only about 35% of costs**. Without fees, it loses money
- **An idle deposit licence:** AMCM granted a deposit-taking non-objection in May 2024, yet **customer deposits were still zero** at end-2025. The balance sheet is funded entirely by a Head Office loan (274.7m), at a rising cost
- **Not yet a real "bank":** the asset side is passively-held bonds (treasury), not actively-managed corporate lending relationships; the liability side has no customer deposits. It lacks a genuine corporate banking franchise

Core insight — three gaps, one answer: (1) income too dependent on lumpy bond fees; (2) a deposit licence held but unused, with the balance sheet funded by expensive Head Office money; (3) NII nowhere near enough to cover costs. The single answer to all three is **to build a genuine corporate banking franchise** — which is exactly why this Corporate Banking Analyst role exists.

How this role solves those challenges

The branch's challenge	How this role (you) solves it
Single engine / income collapse	Corporate banking's loan interest + deposits + transaction-banking fees are recurring and counter-cyclical. They keep earning even when bond markets close — directly fixing the kind of collapse seen in 2025

The branch's challenge	How this role (you) solves it
Idle deposit licence + expensive Head Office funding	Corporate banking relationships bring corporate deposits (cheap, stable) to replace the 274.7m Head Office loan and cut the rising interest expense. Analyst onboarding / KYC is the concrete act that activates the deposit licence
NII covers only 35% of costs	Upgrade the passive bond book into an active, higher-margin corporate loan book . To cover the ~38.6m cost base on NII, the book needs to grow toward ~MOP 2bn — the Analyst is the person who executes that expansion
Protecting asset quality while scaling	Moving from bond treasury to corporate lending raises credit risk. The Analyst's credit analysis, KYC and post-loan monitoring are exactly what keeps the book clean as it scales
Capturing Guotai Haitong cross-border flow	Connect mainland corporate clients (via the merged Guotai Haitong network) to Macau banking + European capital markets, growing the China cross-border business that shrank in 2025

Killer answer: What do you see as the branch's main challenge, and how can you help?

SAY THIS

"From the branch's own disclosures, I can see the franchise is strong on the advisory and DCM side — but it has a structural vulnerability. In 2025 the branch swung from a 54 million pataca profit to a 13 million loss, because fee income fell about 91% when mainland issuers pulled back from offshore bonds. One engine stalled, and the whole branch went into the red.

Meanwhile net interest income covers only about a third of the fixed cost base, and although you've held the AMCM deposit-taking approval since 2024, there's still no customer deposit base — the balance sheet is funded by a 275 million Head Office loan, with interest expense up more than eight times.

That gap is exactly what I fill. Building a corporate banking franchise gives you stable, recurring net interest income to diversify away from lumpy DCM fees, and corporate deposits to replace expensive Head Office funding. At Bank of China I manage an 8 billion HKD loan book and 7 billion in deposit relationships, with over 2 billion US dollars of cross-border execution and a clean compliance record. I can help turn that single-engine model into a real bank — while protecting asset quality as you scale."

If pressed: if asked "where did these numbers come from," say "I read your financial information disclosures filed with AMCM" — that itself proves you treated this interview like the real job. If asked "what about the underwriting business," don't belittle it: "It's a high-value franchise. What I'd add is a second, stable leg so the branch no longer depends on the weather."

12. Memorisation Priority & Pre-Interview Checklist

Memorisation priority

Priority	Item	Why
[MUST] Must	A1 Tell me about yourself	Opening, sets the tone
[MUST] Must	A3 RM applying as Analyst	Almost certainly asked
[MUST] Must	B1 / STAR deal	Core, shows real execution
[MUST] Must	D1 Three-statement linkage	Technical core, frequently tested
[MUST] Must	D5 Free cash flow + DSCR	Technical core, ties to STAR
[MUST] Must	Section 11 challenges answer	Research bomb; position yourself as the solution
[KEY] Key	A2 / C1 / B2 / D3 / E1	Show research, framework, sincerity
[KNOW] Know	All other questions	Understand them; no need to memorise word-for-word

Final pre-interview checklist

- [] Know Haitong Bank S.A. is incorporated in Lisbon, wholly owned by Guotai Haitong, EU-regulated
- [] STAR story filled with your real details, deliverable in 2.5–3 minutes
- [] Can draw the three-statement loop on paper (the interviewer may hand you a pen)
- [] Can name 1–2 GBA cross-border financial policies you've tracked
- [] Prepared 2–3 questions to ask the interviewer
- [] Practised the whiteboard drill: "Depreciation goes up by 10 — what happens to the three statements?"
- [] Reviewed the DSCR formula and the 1.2x healthy line
- [] Reviewed the Section 11 branch numbers cold

Mindset on the day: not "I hope they pick me," but "we are evaluating whether to work together." Make sure that the moment he walks out of the room, the first name in his head is yours.

Good luck with your interview